

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Anti Defection Law - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Anti Defection Law	
REPHRASED EXPLANATORY MATERIAL FOR UPSC EXAMINATION	
01 THE CONSTITUTIONAL PROBLEM: STABILITY WITHOUT LEGISLATIVE SERVITUDE The constitutional design must distinguish principled dissent from	02 BOUNDED HISTORY: FROM "AJAY RAM, GAYA RAM" TO CONSTITUTIONAL DESIGN The 52nd Amendment converted a political instability problem into
03 THE 52ND AMENDMENT: CREATION, ARTICLES AND COMMENCEMENT The Act is dated 15 February 1985 while the Schedule became	04 THE 91ST AMENDMENT: WHAT CHANGED AND WHAT DID NOT Articles 101, 103, 104, and 105 create bounded office disabilities
05 EXACT PARAGRAPH MAP OF THE TENTH SCHEDULE The concept sequence moves from definitions and grounds to	06 DEFINITIONS: POLITICAL PARTY, LEGISLATURE PARTY AND ORIGINAL POLITICAL PARTY Political party, legislature party, legislature party and original
07 GROUND ONE: VOLUNTARILY GIVING UP MEMBERSHIP Rule 1, Rule 10(1) permits an absence from ground conduct, but no	08 GROUND TWO: VOTING OR ABSTAINING CONTRARY TO DIRECTION After permission or combination within fifteen days provides the
09 INDEPENDENT AND NOMINATED MEMBERS An independent has no given period, while a nominated non-party	10 PARAGRAPH 4 MERGER: TEXT, THRESHOLD AND CONTROVERSY It contains original political party merger language with a dissenting
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Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Polity 42 - Anti-Defection Law

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQs 1-36 - Strict Continuous A -> B -> C -> D Rotation

Q1. With reference to the 52nd Amendment, which statement is correct?

A. The Act is dated 15 February 1985, while the Tenth Schedule came into force on 1 March 1985. B. It amended only Articles 102 and 191. C. It came into force on 1 January 2004. D. It inserted the Ninth Schedule.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The 52nd Amendment amended Articles 101, 102, 190 and 191 and inserted the Tenth Schedule; the official consolidation records effect from 1 March 1985.

Q2. "Legislature party" under paragraph 1 most accurately means:

A. the national executive of a political party. B. all members of that House who for the time being belong to that political party under the Schedule. C. any faction supported by two-thirds of the House. D. only elected members, excluding nominated members.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] It is a House-specific group. It is not the party organisation or any self-declared faction.

Q3. A nominated member who was not a party member at nomination:

A. can never join a party. B. is treated exactly like an independent elected member. C. may join within six months from taking the seat without paragraph 2(3) disqualification. D. may join only after six months.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The first-six-month choice window is specific to the nominated member.

Q4. An independently elected member is disqualified if the member:

A. declines ministerial office. B. criticises a political party. C. abstains on a non-whipped motion. D. joins any political party after election.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Paragraph 2(2) provides no six-month grace period.

Q5. Which best states Ravi S. Naik?

A. Voluntarily giving up membership may be inferred from conduct and is not confined to formal resignation. B. Only a written resignation can establish defection. C. Expulsion automatically ends Tenth Schedule membership. D. ECI decides conduct-based defection.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The phrase is wider than formal resignation, though inference remains evidence- and context-dependent.

Q6. Paragraph 2(1)(b) requires, among other things:

A. a criminal conviction. B. contrary vote/abstention without prior permission and no condonation within 15 days. C. a formal party resignation. D. a direction only from the legislature party.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Direction, contrary voting/abstention, no prior permission and no timely condonation form the textual chain.

Q7. After Subhash Desai, the authorised Whip for Tenth Schedule purposes is appointed by:

A. the largest faction in the legislature party. B. the Governor. C. the political party. D. the Election Commission.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The political party, not merely the legislature party, appoints the Whip and Leader.

Q8. Which conduct is least capable, by itself, of establishing paragraph 2(1)(b)?

A. voting without prior permission and without condonation. B. voting contrary to a valid direction. C. abstaining contrary to a valid direction. D. making a dissenting speech without a contrary vote or abstention.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [LIMIT] The constitutional voting ground is not a general speech-control provision.

Q9. Paragraph 4 protection requires:

A. a merger framework and not less than two-thirds of the legislature party agreeing to the merger. B. only a public statement by the defecting members. C. approval by the Governor. D. one-third of the legislature party forming a faction.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Two-thirds operates within paragraph 4's merger structure.

Q10. Paragraph 3 of the Tenth Schedule:

A. creates judicial review. B. was omitted by the 91st Amendment. C. protects nominated members. D. gives ECI jurisdiction.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The former one-third split defence ceased with effect from 1 January 2004.

Q11. Paragraph 5 protection can apply to:

A. every minister. B. every committee chair. C. a listed Speaker/Deputy Speaker or Chairman/Deputy Chairman who satisfies the conditions. D. every constitutional officeholder.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] It is an exact office-and-condition exemption, not a general neutrality clause.

Q12. If the disqualification question concerns the Speaker:

A. ECI decides. B. the Governor decides. C. the Deputy Speaker automatically decides. D. a member elected by the House for that purpose decides.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] This is the proviso to paragraph 6(1).

Q13. The current legal effect of paragraph 7 is that:

A. its printed court-bar text remains, but it is invalid under *Kihoto* for want of ratification. B. it transfers jurisdiction to ECI. C. it fully excludes judicial review. D. it was omitted by the 91st Amendment.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The official 2026 Constitution includes the text and the invalidity footnote.

Q14. Kihoto permits review for:

A. only delay. B. constitutional violation, mala fides, natural-justice breach and perversity. C. only a criminal offence. D. every factual disagreement as a full appeal.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The review is limited to jurisdictional/constitutional infirmities.

Q15. Ordinary interlocutory court interference under Kihoto is:

A. identical to appellate review. B. controlled by ECI. C. generally excluded, subject to grave and irreversible interlocutory consequences. D. mandatory in every petition.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The baseline protects first-instance Speaker adjudication while preserving a narrow exception.

Q16. On decision time, the Tenth Schedule:

A. fixes 15 days. B. fixes three months expressly. C. fixes 30 days. D. contains no express deadline.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] The three-month norm comes from *Keisham*, not the text.

Q17. Keisham Meghachandra Singh stated that, absent exceptional circumstances:

A. three months is the ordinary outer limit and Parliament should consider an independent tribunal. B. delay is wholly non-justiciable. C. every petition must go directly to the Supreme Court. D. ECI must decide in 15 days.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The Court tied reasonable time to the Schedule's constitutional objective.

Q18. The official 31 July 2025 Telangana judgment:

A. imposed criminal punishment. B. directed conclusion of specified proceedings within three months. C. finally settled every future timeline case. D. abolished Speaker jurisdiction.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] It was a case-specific judicial direction, not a constitutional amendment.

Q19. Under Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil, a resignation tendered after the alleged defection:

A. automatically ends the petition. B. creates a permanent election bar. C. does not erase prior defection or the Speaker's jurisdiction. D. transfers the case to ECI.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Disqualification relates to the date of the defection act.

Q20. The Speaker's power after disqualification includes:

A. barring all future elections. B. imposing any politically desirable penalty. C. ordering imprisonment. D. no power to add a term-long election-contest ban beyond the Constitution.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] *Shrimanth* struck down the extra duration/election restriction.

Q21. Articles 75(1B), 164(1B) and 361B:

A. create specified ministerial/remunerative-post disabilities after paragraph 2 disqualification. B. protect a one-third split. C. transfer defection cases to the President. D. prohibit contesting every election.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The disabilities last until term expiry or earlier declared re-election, whichever is earlier.

Q22. ECI's role in a Tenth Schedule petition is:

A. issuing the party whip. B. no paragraph 6 adjudicatory role. C. automatic appellate authority. D. first-instance adjudication.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] ECI has separate symbol and Articles 103/192 functions.

Q23. According to Subhash Desai, symbol and defection proceedings:

A. are both decided by the Governor. B. must be merged in the Supreme Court. C. may proceed concurrently before ECI and Speaker on separate tracks. D. cannot coexist.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] One proceeding does not automatically suspend the other.

Q24. The Governor's role in a live party split is best stated as:

A. deciding who defected. B. appointing the party Whip. C. deciding the symbol dispute. D. exercising constitutional government-formation/floor-test functions without replacing Speaker or ECI jurisdictions.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] *Subhash Desai* keeps institutional tracks distinct and requires objective material.

Q25. As controlled for this package, Nabam Rebia:

A. remains a rule whose correctness was referred to seven judges in *Subhash Desai*, with no later verified merits ruling used here. B. concerns nominated members. C. was conclusively overruled in 2023. D. abolished judicial review.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [CURRENT] [LIMIT] A reference is not itself an overruling.

Q26. Which is a direct legal consequence of Tenth Schedule disqualification?

A. cancellation of party registration. B. vacancy of the seat. C. criminal conviction. D. permanent ban from politics.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The Schedule concerns membership, with linked constitutional office bars.

Q27. Party expulsion of a legislator:

A. automatically makes the person independent. B. transfers the seat to the party. C. does not by itself erase deemed original-party belonging for Tenth Schedule purposes. D. automatically disqualifies under paragraph 2.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] G. *Viswanathan* prevents the “unattached” label from defeating the Schedule.

Q28. A post-election office-of-profit or RPA disqualification question for a sitting State member is ordinarily decided by:

A. ECI alone. B. Speaker under paragraph 6. C. Chief Minister. D. Governor under Article 192 after obtaining and acting according to ECI opinion.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] This differs from the Tenth Schedule route.

Q29. Breach of privilege and defection:

A. are distinct constitutional regimes even though paragraph 8 rules may address wilful rule contravention like privilege. B. are both decided by ECI. C. are always identical. D. always produce permanent disqualification.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Their protected interests, grounds and procedures differ.

Q30. The strongest democratic defence of anti-defection is:

A. it makes courts unnecessary. B. it protects government stability and the party-linked electoral mandate. C. it eliminates all corruption. D. party leaders should control every speech.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] The defence is substantial but must be balanced against deliberative freedom.

Q31. A narrow-whip reform would most plausibly:

A. remove all confidence discipline. B. give ECI power to legislate. C. confine seat-risk directions to confidence, money/supply or core matters. D. abolish parties.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] The goal is calibrated party discipline, not no discipline.

Q32. The safest statement on paragraph 4 controversy is:

A. two-thirds can always defect freely. B. original-party text is irrelevant. C. the issue was conclusively settled in 2026. D. exact text and competing interpretations must be stated; no unverified final 2026 rule should be claimed.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [CURRENT] [LIMIT] The package preserves the unresolved interpretive question.

Q33. Under official Lok Sabha procedure, a compliant petition is followed by:

A. service of copies/comments and a reasonable opportunity before an adverse finding. B. immediate automatic vacancy. C. ECI investigation. D. a criminal trial.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The procedure reflects the adjudicatory nature recognised in *Kihoto*.

Q34. Paragraph 6(2)'s deeming of proceedings as legislative proceedings:

A. eliminates natural justice. B. protects against mere procedural-irregularity attacks but not jurisdictional constitutional review. C. removes every court power. D. makes the Speaker a political party officer.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] *Kihoto* limits, rather than abolishes, review.

Q35. The 2025 routed concept emphasising “political party” is best answered by noting:

A. ECI becomes the defection tribunal. B. only legislature-party numbers matter. C. the Schedule links candidate-setting, membership and directions to the political party. D. political parties are not mentioned in paragraph 2.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The phrase is structurally central to the Schedule.

Q36. Which statement about a nominated member is correct?

A. a party can be joined only after six months. B. joining at any time is prohibited. C. the six-month period runs from nomination. D. joining within six months from taking the seat is permitted without paragraph 2(3) disqualification.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] This is the exact distinction tested by the 2022 route.

Remedial MCQs 37-48 - Same Continuous Rotation

Q37. A member votes against a valid direction but receives condonation from the authorised party authority on day 12. The best conclusion is:

A. paragraph 2(1)(b) disqualification does not arise on that vote because condonation occurred within 15 days. B. condonation must occur before voting. C. disqualification is automatic at the moment of voting. D. only ECI can condone.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Prior permission and post-vote condonation within 15 days are separate textual protections.

Q38. A group containing exactly one-third of a legislature party claims a split in 2026. It is:

A. protected by old paragraph 3. B. not protected because paragraph 3 stands omitted. C. protected if the Governor agrees. D. automatically a merger.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The one-third split defence ended on 1 January 2004.

Q39. Two-thirds of a legislature party announce that they have “merged”, while the original party denies any merger. The best exam answer is:

A. ECI must disqualify them. B. they are automatically criminals. C. apply paragraph 4's exact original-party and deeming text and identify the unresolved interpretive controversy. D. they are automatically protected.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [LIMIT] A categorical numerical shortcut would erase the legal controversy.

Q40. A court is asked to stop the Speaker from deciding merely because an adverse decision is feared. The *Kihoto* baseline is:

A. ECI reference. B. Governor's permission. C. automatic injunction. D. no ordinary quia timet intervention before decision.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Courts generally do not pre-empt the constitutionally assigned adjudicator.

Q41. A Speaker sits on a petition until the Assembly term is nearly over. Which chain is most relevant?

A. *Rajendra Singh Rana* -> *Keisham* -> judicial direction against disabling inaction. B. parliamentary privilege exclusively. C. Article 352 -> emergency. D. ECI Symbols Order only.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Delay cannot be used to frustrate the Schedule's constitutional objective.

Q42. A disqualified member wins a by-election before the old term ends. The 91st-Amendment office disability:

A. necessarily lasts for life. B. ends on declared re-election if that occurs earlier than original term expiry. C. becomes criminal punishment. D. is decided by the party whip.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Articles 75(1B), 164(1B) and 361B use the earlier-event formula.

Q43. An expelled member joins another political party. The most relevant authority is:

A. *Minerva Mills*. B. *Bommai*. C. *G. Viswanathan*. D. *Kesavananda Bharati*.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Deemed original-party belonging continues for Tenth Schedule purposes.

Q44. Which proposition is outside Subhash Desai?

A. Speaker and ECI tracks may proceed concurrently. B. split defence is unavailable. C. political party appoints the Whip. D. the Supreme Court itself disqualified every disputed member.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [LIMIT] The Court left first-instance disqualification to the Speaker.

Q45. The best way to write paragraph 7 is:

A. "It textually bars courts, but *Kihoto* invalidated it for want of State ratification." B. "It concerns merger." C. "It is fully operative." D. "It was deleted by Parliament."

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] This preserves both text and legal effect.

Q46. A proposal to vest defection decisions in the President/Governor on ECI advice would:

A. describe existing paragraph 6. B. require legal/constitutional change and mirrors the Articles 103/192 model. C. be implemented by a party whip. D. automatically solve every bias concern.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] [LIMIT] It shifts institutional risk; it is not current law.

Q47. Which reform most directly addresses loss of ordinary legislative deliberation?

A. broader whips. B. longer Speaker delay. C. limiting binding whips to survival/core votes. D. making defection criminal.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] It protects necessary stability while restoring issue-wise judgment.

Q48. The best final verdict on the law is:

A. wholly useless. B. unconstitutional in its entirety. C. perfectly effective. D. justified in principle but weakened by broad whips, group/resignation routes and partisan delay.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] A graded verdict recognises both stability gains and design failures.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Anti-Defection PYQ and Practice Workbook

[FACT] Audited local routing identifies two direct Prelims demands and one cross-owned Mains demand relevant to this package.

[FACT] Exact wording and answer letters for the two objective questions were checked against the UPSC question-paper/answer-key record; the routing ledgers establish topic ownership. The 2023 GS-II wording, marks and word limit were also verified.

Visual 71 - Verified PYQ Route Map

Year	Stage	Q	Verified neutral demand	Key/wording control
2022	Prelims GS-I	16	nominated member and absence of a decision time-frame	official answer: B (2 only)
2025	Prelims GS-I	88	Tenth Schedule decider and mention of political party	official answer: D (neither I nor II)
2023	Mains GS-II	5	role of State presiding officers in order and impartial conduct	10 marks, 150 words

Caption: The package solves the concepts without inventing missing official keys or wording.

Routed Prelims PYQ 1 - 2022 GS-I Q16

Exact question: With reference to anti-defection law in India, consider the following statements:

1. The law specifies that a nominated legislator cannot join any political party within six months of being appointed to the House.
2. The law does not provide any time-frame within which the presiding officer has to decide a defection case.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct? A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Official answer: B - 2 only.

Resolution: Statement 1 is incorrect because paragraph 2(3) permits a nominated member to join within six months from taking the seat and disqualifies joining after that period. Statement 2 is correct because the Schedule contains no express decision deadline; *Keisham Meghachandra Singh* (2020) later stated an ordinary three-month judicial norm absent exceptional circumstances.

Routed Prelims PYQ 2 - 2025 GS-I Q88

Exact question: Consider the following statements:

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the Tenth Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct? A. I only B. II only C. Both I and II D. Neither I nor II

Official answer: D - Neither I nor II.

Resolution: Statement I is incorrect because paragraph 6 assigns the initial decision to the Speaker/Chairman, not the President acting on ministerial advice. Statement II is incorrect because the Tenth Schedule repeatedly uses "political party". Do not confuse this route with Article 103 questions under Article 102(1), where the President acts on the Election Commission's opinion.

Routed Mains PYQ - 2023 GS-II Q5

Exact question: "Discuss the role of Presiding Officers of state legislatures in maintaining order and impartiality in conducting legislative work and in facilitating best democratic practices." **GS-II | 10 marks | 150 words**

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] State presiding officers are procedural guardians whose powers over debate, discipline, voting and defection make impartiality a constitutional operating condition.

1. [CLAIM] They maintain orderly deliberation. [EVIDENCE] Articles 178-185 create the offices; House rules govern recognition, admissibility, discipline and voting. [ANALYSIS] fair allocation of speaking and motion time protects majority decision and opposition scrutiny. [LIMIT] broad procedural discretion requires consistent reasons.
2. [CLAIM] They perform high-impact constitutional functions. [EVIDENCE] Article 189 supplies the casting vote, Article 199 involves Money Bill certification, and paragraph 6 of the Tenth Schedule assigns defection adjudication. [ANALYSIS] these decisions can affect bicameral scrutiny and government survival. [LIMIT] political membership creates an appearance-of-bias risk.
3. [CLAIM] Judicial control supports impartiality. [EVIDENCE] *Kihoto Hollohan* treats the Speaker as a reviewable tribunal; *Keisham* requires reasonable-time decision-making. [ANALYSIS] legality and timeliness prevent procedure from becoming partisan strategy. [LIMIT] the proposed independent tribunal is not enacted.

Verdict: Impartiality should be institutionalised through reasoned rulings, equal procedure, timely decisions and neutral defection adjudication, not left to personal convention alone.

Why this earns marks: It connects functions to impartiality, uses Articles and cases, and avoids a generic list of Speaker powers.

How to improve this answer: In the exam, compress the three numbered dimensions to one sentence each and reserve 25-30 words for reforms. Improve further by naming one House-rule example and explicitly linking timely defection rulings to "best democratic practices".

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Visual 72 - MCQ Rotation Plan

Q1 A -> Q2 B -> Q3 C -> Q4 D
repeat without interruption through Q48

Original MCQs: Q1-Q36
Remedials: Q37-Q48

Caption: The answer-key sequence is continuous across both practice blocks.

Visual 73 - Solved-Mains Evidence Bank

Issue	Constitutional anchor	Case/reform anchor
grounds	paragraph 2	<i>Ravi S. Naik</i>
merger	paragraph 4	<i>Rajendra Singh Rana</i> analogy; current controversy
Speaker	paragraph 6	<i>Kihoto</i> , <i>Keisham</i>
resignation	Articles 101/190	<i>Shrimanth</i>
whip authority	paragraph 2(1)(b)	<i>Subhash Desai</i>
office consequence	75(1B), 164(1B), 361B	91st Amendment
reform	constitutional amendment	Goswami, Law Commission, <i>Keisham</i>

Caption: Each model answer should select only evidence that advances its thesis.

Original Mains 1 - Grounds and Member Types (10 marks, 150 words)

Question: Explain the grounds of disqualification under the Tenth Schedule and the distinct treatment of independent and nominated members.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] Paragraph 2 uses different rules because party-ticket, independent and nominated members enter the House with different electoral relationships.

1. [CLAIM] A party member faces two grounds. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 2(1)(a) covers voluntarily giving up membership; *Ravi S. Naik* permits inference from conduct. Paragraph 2(1)(b) covers contrary voting/abstention without prior permission and without condonation within 15 days. [ANALYSIS] The first protects continuing allegiance; the second enforces authorised voting discipline. [LIMIT] every speech or dissent is not a whip breach.
2. [CLAIM] An independent member has the strictest joining rule. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 2(2) disqualifies on joining any party after election. [ANALYSIS] The voter chose a non-party candidate. [LIMIT] no six-month window exists.
3. [CLAIM] A nominated member receives a limited choice period. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 2(3) disqualifies only for joining after six months from taking the seat. [ANALYSIS] The text permits early political alignment. [LIMIT] the clock does not run from nomination.

Verdict: The Schedule protects the electoral identity through category-specific rules rather than one universal prohibition.

Why this earns marks: It states every ground, supplies the 15-day and six-month controls, and uses *Ravi S. Naik* with a qualification.

How to improve this answer: Use a three-row member-type table in rough work, then write one sentence per category. Improve by stating that the nominated-member clock runs from taking the seat and by separating prior permission from 15-day condonation.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 2 - Political Party and Legislature Party (10 marks, 150 words)

Question: Distinguish “political party” from “legislature party” under the Tenth Schedule. Why does the distinction matter?

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] A political party is the organisational/electoral entity; a legislature party is its group of members within a particular House.

- [CLAIM] Electoral belonging flows from the political party. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 2 deems an elected member to belong to the party that set the member up. [ANALYSIS] Voter mandate cannot be rewritten only by House-level numbers. [LIMIT] membership disputes still require evidence.
- [CLAIM] Voting authority flows from the political party. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 2(1)(b) recognises its direction or an authorised person's direction; *Subhash Desai* holds that the political party appoints the Whip and Leader. [ANALYSIS] A factional legislature majority cannot manufacture a rival whip. [LIMIT] the Speaker must identify authorisation through inquiry and party rules.
- [CLAIM] Legislature-party numbers matter in paragraph 4. [EVIDENCE] two-thirds agreement triggers the merger deeming rule. [ANALYSIS] This creates the present organisational-versus-numerical controversy. [LIMIT] two-thirds is not a free-standing right to defect.

Verdict: The distinction protects party mandate while exposing the unresolved tension in the merger exception.

Why this earns marks: It defines, applies and qualifies the distinction through both paragraph 2 and paragraph 4.

How to improve this answer: Compress to definition -> two legal uses -> merger qualification. Improve by quoting “set up as a candidate” and explaining that legislature-party numbers matter only within a specified Schedule mechanism.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 3 - Speaker as Adjudicator (10 marks, 150 words)

Question: Evaluate the constitutional position of the Speaker as the adjudicator of defection petitions.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] Paragraph 6 entrusts the Speaker/Chairman with first-instance decision, but judicial doctrine treats that role as adjudicatory rather than politically immune.

1. [CLAIM] The arrangement keeps the question within the House. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 6 declares the decision final and provides a House-elected substitute when the Speaker is personally concerned. [ANALYSIS] institutional familiarity may aid speed. [LIMIT] continued party affiliation creates perceived bias.
2. [CLAIM] Finality is constitutionally controlled. [EVIDENCE] *Kihoto Hollohan* classifies the Speaker as a tribunal and permits review for constitutional breach, mala fides, natural-justice violation and perversity. [ANALYSIS] legality survives the finality clause. [LIMIT] review is not a full appeal.
3. [CLAIM] delay is a structural weakness. [EVIDENCE] *Keisham* identifies an ordinary three-month outer limit and proposes an independent tribunal. [ANALYSIS] delayed justice can alter government survival. [LIMIT] no express Schedule deadline or tribunal amendment exists.

Verdict: The current model is legally reviewable but institutionally fragile; neutral, time-bound adjudication is the stronger design.

Why this earns marks: It balances constitutional text, judicial control, practical bias and reform within the word limit.

How to improve this answer: Spend about 35 words each on text, review and delay, then give a two-line verdict. Improve by distinguishing paragraph 6 finality from paragraph 7 invalidity and by avoiding the claim that ECI currently decides defection.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 4 - Kihoto and Judicial Review (15 marks, 250 words)

Question: "Kihoto Hollohan saved the anti-defection law from both invalidation and unaccountability." Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] *Kihoto* upheld the central Tenth Schedule design while invalidating its attempted total ouster of courts, producing a controlled compromise between House adjudication and constitutional review.

Saved from invalidation

- [CLAIM] The majority rejected the argument that vesting power in the Speaker necessarily destroyed the basic structure. [EVIDENCE] It emphasised the high constitutional office and retained paragraph 6. [ANALYSIS] This preserved the 52nd Amendment's anti-defection mechanism. [LIMIT] the minority's bias concern later informed reform debate.

Saved from unaccountability

- [CLAIM] Paragraph 7 could not validly exclude Supreme Court/High Court jurisdiction. [EVIDENCE] It affected Articles 136, 226 and 227 but lacked ratification by half the States under Article 368(2). [ANALYSIS] amendment procedure protected federal participation and judicial review. [LIMIT] paragraph 7 remains printed but legally invalid.
- [CLAIM] The Speaker is a tribunal. [EVIDENCE] Review survives for constitutional mandate violation, mala fides, natural-justice breach and perversity. [ANALYSIS] a political office exercising judicial power must give a legally defensible order. [LIMIT] review is jurisdictional, not a routine merits appeal.
- [CLAIM] First-instance authority remains with the Speaker. [EVIDENCE] ordinary quia timet/interlocutory intervention is restricted. [ANALYSIS] this respects constitutional allocation. [LIMIT] *Keisham* later clarifies that courts may aid prompt decision against inaction.

Verdict: *Kihoto* did not perfect the law; it constitutionalised accountability around a structurally partisan decider. Later delay cases expose why judicial review is necessary but not sufficient.

Why this earns marks: It answers both halves of the quotation, explains ratification, review grounds and timing, and adds a measured limitation.

How to improve this answer: Compress the answer into two labelled halves-validity and accountability-before the verdict. Improve by naming Articles 136, 226 and 227 and stating that ordinary pre-decision intervention remains exceptional.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 5 - Merger Exception (15 marks, 250 words)

Question: "The merger exception risks converting a prohibition on defection into a numerical licence for wholesale defection." Critically examine.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] Paragraph 4 protects genuine party merger, but its two-thirds deeming rule can be used to present coordinated legislative migration as constitutional realignment.

Why protection exists

- [CLAIM] Parties may genuinely reorganise. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 4 protects members accepting another/new party and those rejecting the merger and functioning separately. [ANALYSIS] A rigid individual-only rule could punish authentic collective realignment. [LIMIT] protection must remain tied to merger, not convenience.

Why it becomes a loophole

- [CLAIM] The threshold rewards group engineering. [EVIDENCE] not less than two-thirds of the legislature party triggers the deeming rule after the one-third split defence was deleted. [ANALYSIS] actors rationally aggregate numbers rather than defect individually. [LIMIT] threshold alone does not answer the original-political-party language.
- [CLAIM] Organisational mandate may be bypassed. [EVIDENCE] Paragraph 4(1) speaks of the original political party merging; *Subhash Desai* elsewhere stresses political-party authority over mere legislature factions. [ANALYSIS] voter choice is weakened if House numbers can rewrite party identity. [LIMIT] paragraph 4(2)'s deeming fiction creates a genuine interpretive dispute.
- [CLAIM] *Rajendra Singh Rana* supplies a cautionary analogy. [EVIDENCE] under old paragraph 3, legislator numbers did not themselves prove an original-party split. [ANALYSIS] organisational reality matters. [LIMIT] that case interpreted the now-omitted split rule, not a final modern merger rule.

Reform: Clarify organisational consent/evidence, redesign or remove the defence, and protect only transparent, genuine mergers followed by electoral accountability.

Verdict: Paragraph 4 should remain an exception proved strictly, not a numerical safe harbour presumed automatically.

Why this earns marks: It preserves the textual controversy, gives both rationales and avoids claiming an unverified 2026 settlement.

How to improve this answer: Use paragraph 4(1) and 4(2) as the organising axis, not political examples. Improve by separating a genuine organisational merger from the two-thirds deeming rule and by labelling *Rajendra Singh Rana* only as an analogy.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 6 - Resignation and Office Bars (15 marks, 250 words)

Question: Analyse the relationship between resignation, defection disqualification and the office disabilities introduced by the 91st Amendment.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] Resignation and disqualification are distinct vacancy mechanisms; the 91st Amendment prevents a person adjudged a defector from immediately converting seat loss into ministerial or remunerative office.

Resignation does not erase prior defection

- [CLAIM] Liability is tied to the defection date. [EVIDENCE] *Shrimanth Balasaheb Patil* holds that a later resignation does not vaporise the taint or terminate Speaker jurisdiction. [ANALYSIS] otherwise a member could defeat paragraph 2 by timing a resignation. [LIMIT] the Speaker still must prove the ground through fair process.

Disqualification does not create an unlimited election ban

- [CLAIM] The Speaker's power is text-bound. [EVIDENCE] *Shrimanth* struck down the direction barring re-election until the Assembly term ended. [ANALYSIS] desirability cannot supply a qualification absent from the Constitution/RPA. [LIMIT] re-election does not retrospectively validate the earlier conduct.

91st-Amendment disabilities

- [CLAIM] Articles 75(1B) and 164(1B) bar ministerial appointment; Article 361B bars a remunerative political post. [EVIDENCE] each runs from disqualification until original term expiry or earlier declared re-election. [ANALYSIS] this targets the office reward that can motivate defection. [LIMIT] it is not criminal punishment or lifetime exclusion.

Verdict: The scheme now follows a calibrated sequence: adjudicate past defection despite resignation, vacate the seat, impose temporary office disability, but preserve the electorate's power to return the candidate.

Why this earns marks: It separates three legal mechanisms, uses the controlling case and states the exact duration formula.

How to improve this answer: Write the events chronologically: alleged act -> resignation -> adjudication -> office disability -> possible re-election. Improve by stating "declared elected" and "whichever earlier", rather than the loose phrase "until re-election or term end".

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 7 - Effectiveness and Reform (20 marks, 300 words)

Question: Has the anti-defection law strengthened parliamentary democracy or reduced legislators to agents of party leadership? Critically examine and suggest reforms.

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Tenth Schedule strengthened government stability and party-linked electoral accountability, but its broad whip, merger incentives and partisan adjudication weakened deliberative representation. It is a necessary principle with an overbroad and poorly enforced design.

Democratic gains

1. [CLAIM] It raises the cost of opportunistic floor-crossing. [EVIDENCE] the 52nd Amendment constitutionalised seat loss for voluntary abandonment and whip defiance. [ANALYSIS] this protects the voter from office-driven mandate trading. [LIMIT] it cannot eliminate incentives.
2. [CLAIM] It stabilises responsible government. [EVIDENCE] confidence arithmetic becomes more predictable. [ANALYSIS] ministries can implement programmes. [LIMIT] stability without scrutiny may become executive dominance.
3. [CLAIM] It recognises political parties as constitutional actors. [EVIDENCE] candidate-setting, membership and directions all refer to the political party. [ANALYSIS] party labels shape electoral choice. [LIMIT] party leadership may be internally undemocratic.

Democratic costs

1. [CLAIM] Broad whips chill judgment. [EVIDENCE] paragraph 2(1)(b) is not confined to confidence or money votes. [ANALYSIS] legislators become numbers rather than deliberators. [LIMIT] core survival votes justify stronger discipline.
2. [CLAIM] Group and resignation routes displace individual defection. [EVIDENCE] paragraph 4 and *Shrimanth* reveal merger/resignation strategies. [ANALYSIS] the law redirects rather than removes defections. [LIMIT] genuine merger and resignation remain legitimate constitutional possibilities.
3. [CLAIM] Speaker timing can determine political outcomes. [EVIDENCE] *Kihoto*, *Rajendra Singh Rana*, *Keisham* and the 2025 Telangana direction. [ANALYSIS] delayed adjudication can make final review hollow. [LIMIT] complex cases may require justified extension.

Reforms

- narrow binding whips to confidence/no-confidence, money/supply and clearly defined core commitments;
- create an independent tribunal or a carefully insulated President/Governor-on-ECI-advice model;
- enact a fixed deadline with reasoned exceptional extension;
- redesign paragraph 4 to require transparent proof of genuine organisational merger;
- require recorded party authorisation and strengthen internal party democracy;
- preserve judicial review and natural justice.

Verdict: Anti-defection should protect the mandate at moments of government survival, not extinguish representative judgment throughout legislative life.

Why this earns marks: It balances achievement and harm, uses eight named anchors, explains mechanisms and offers matched reforms.

How to improve this answer: For 300 words, use two gains, three costs and four matched reforms; drop secondary examples before dropping constitutional anchors. Improve by linking each reform to a diagnosed failure-whip breadth, Speaker bias, delay or merger engineering.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.

Original Mains 8 - Maharashtra Institutional Conflict (20 marks, 300 words)

Question: Using *Subhash Desai*, analyse how the Tenth Schedule distributes authority among the political party, legislature party, Speaker, Election Commission, Governor and courts.

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] *Subhash Desai* rejects a single-institution solution to a party split. It assigns each institution a legally bounded function and prevents legislative headcount from silently replacing political-party authority.

Political party and legislature party

- [CLAIM] The political party controls authorised legislative direction. [EVIDENCE] it appoints the Whip and Leader; paragraph 2 links the member to the party that set the candidate up. [ANALYSIS] a factional legislature majority cannot self-authorise a rival whip. [LIMIT] the Speaker must determine authentic authority through the party constitution and evidence.
- [CLAIM] Legislature-party numbers remain relevant but not sovereign. [EVIDENCE] paragraph 4 uses the two-thirds threshold. [ANALYSIS] numbers serve a defined constitutional defence. [LIMIT] they do not automatically settle party identity.

Speaker and ECI

- [CLAIM] The Speaker decides paragraph 6 petitions. [EVIDENCE] *Kihoto* tribunal doctrine and *Subhash Desai* first-instance rule. [ANALYSIS] membership liability remains House-linked. [LIMIT] decisions must be timely and reviewable.
- [CLAIM] ECI decides the separate Symbols Order dispute. [EVIDENCE] *Subhash Desai* permits concurrent proceedings. [ANALYSIS] symbol recognition and defection ask different legal questions. [LIMIT] neither result mechanically controls the other.

Governor and courts

- [CLAIM] The Governor may use constitutionally relevant objective material for government formation/floor test, but cannot decide defection. [EVIDENCE] the impugned floor-test call lacked objective material; later government invitation after vacancy was upheld. [ANALYSIS] majority testing cannot become an indirect party-recognition mechanism. [LIMIT] facts and timing matter.
- [CLAIM] Courts police boundaries. [EVIDENCE] judicial review remains; the Court did not ordinarily decide disqualifications first instance. [ANALYSIS] constitutional supervision preserves distributed authority. [LIMIT] *Nabam Rebia* correctness remains referred.

Verdict: The judgment's enduring principle is jurisdictional discipline: political authority, legislative grouping, membership adjudication, symbol recognition and government formation must interact without collapsing into one another.

Why this earns marks: It addresses all six institutions, uses exact holdings and preserves the unresolved *Nabam Rebia* issue.

How to improve this answer: Use a six-box jurisdiction map in rough work and give each institution one verb. Improve by separating Speaker party-identification for Schedule purposes from ECI symbol adjudication and by stating that the seven-judge reference has not produced a verified merits ruling as of 28 August 2026.

Compression plan: Retain the thesis, exact constitutional anchor, one controlling case, one qualification and the verdict; remove examples before legal controls.